

1946, March 23rd

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

St. Michael's Church
225 Jerome Street
Brooklyn 7, N.Y.

March 23rd 1946.

Mr. and Mrs. Joseph J. O'Donnell.
1120 Lake Shore Drive,
Chicago, Illinois.

My Dear Friends:

God bless you and yours. Many thanks for your generous favor of March 19, duly received and noted.

I am surely pleased to know of your privileged trip to the famous Shrine of Guadalupe, and especially of the hoped-for improvement in your health as surely a part consequence. I surely congratulate you and Mrs. O'Donnell on such a pleasant and praiseworthy experience.
Deo Gr.

Now in regard to the laudable proposition you dream about, viz, the education of a candidate for the Holy Priesthood: I would consider such a proposition as always more or less of a supernatural inspiration. There is so much call for such activity - real Catholic Action - that, as I believe, there are comparatively few outside the Bishops and Superiors of the different Orders who realize its crying necessity.

Personally and just at present, however, I would be reluctant to advise in such a proposition, when I know of others, in consequence of their office or position who would be pleased and better able to guide you than I might.

Hence I am referring your laudable proposition/our Father Provincial, the very Rev. Father Clement, O.F.M.Cap. who's address is
1740 Mt.Elliott Ave.Detroit 7, Mich.

He, perhaps better than anyone in the Province of Saint Joseph, would know best how to advise in such matters. I do know that the education of poor students and candidates has always been quite a problem in our educational institutions. Often some of the brightest and most promising students come from poor families and I am quite sure we have never as yet "turned down" on account of financial shortage. However, it is none the less quite a problem for the Province of St. Joseph - your own dear Patron.

So I am sure that whatever you may see able and disposed to do for the Province/ would be gratefully appreciated.

Again wishing you God's blessing, I beg to remain

Very Sincerely Your in Christ.

Fr. Solanus, O.F.M.Cap.